



Middle Georgia
State University

School of Computing
Department of Information Technology

SECTION 1 - GENERAL COURSE INFORMATION

Course Title:	Java Programming
Course Prefix and Number:	ITEC 4261-02
Course CRN#:	25266
Semester & Session:	Spring 2025, Full Session
Campus Location:	Asynchronous Online
Meeting Days:	Asynchronous Online
Meeting Time:	Asynchronous Online

INSTRUCTOR'S INFORMATION

Name:	Dr. Douglas Malcolm DSc, MBA & MSIS, BSCS Assistant Professor of Information Technology	
E-mail Address:	Douglas.Malcolm@mga.edu	
Office Location:	PSC 328	
Office Phone Number:	478-471-3615 or via Microsoft Teams	
Tentative Office Hours:	Tuesdays	1pm EST to 5pm EST
	Thursdays	1pm EST to 5pm EST

SECTION 2 - DETAILED COURSE INFORMATION

Course Prerequisite:	At least a C in ITEC 2270 or CSCI 1302
Credit Hours:	3
Course Description:	Java is one of the most popular object-oriented programming languages, especially widely used in the modern web and mobile environment. This course focuses on core concepts of object-oriented programming and explores fundamental programming structures and various features of Java. Topics will include OOP design, data types, object and class, interfaces, inheritance, event handling, swing, exceptions, generic programming, collections, and multithreading.
Student learning outcomes:	Upon completion of this course the students will be able to: • Learn data types and operations on data • Learn Java fundamental classes (String, Array, List, ArrayList, etc.) • Learn design and implementation of classes using object-oriented programming concepts such as encapsulation, inheritance, and polymorphism • Learn the use and implementation of interfaces • Learn about writing recursive methods • Learn about implementation of data structures • Learn about analyzing problems and writing Java program solutions to those problems using the above features.
Topics:	• Object-oriented design • Data types • Objects and classes • Interfaces • Inheritance • Event handling • Swing • Exceptions • Generic programming • Collections
Required course materials:	Intro to Java Programming and Data Structures, Comprehensive Version (12th), Author: Daniel Liang, Publisher: Pearson, ISBN: 978-0136520238
Technology Requirement:	Computer with Java SE Development Kit, text editor/IDE and word processing software
Library/Learning Resources:	As a Middle Georgia State University student, you have complete access to GALILEO (Georgia Library Learning Online), a virtual library of licensed commercial databases. It provides access to over 100 databases indexing thousands of periodicals and scholarly journals. There are over 10,000 journal titles available in full-text. Additional GALILEO resources include e-books, government documents, reference collections, and video databases. The Middle Georgia State University library also has core collection with locally purchased resources to support this graduate course. Currently the exclusive holdings for the B.S. / M.S. in Information Technology graduate courses are as follows: e-Journals = 1,661, Print Books = 1,164, e-books = 4,325, and DVDs = 66. The following are examples of online databases that support this undergraduate course. They are available to you through GALILEO and/or institutionally funded subscriptions: • ACM Digital Library • Computer Source

- Computing (ProQuest)
- Academic Search Complete
- Research Library (ProQuest)
- Wilson Omnifile: Full-Text Mega Edition
- Google Scholar
- Films on Demand

Tutoring is available free of charge on all MGA campuses for currently enrolled students. To view center contact information, subjects tutored, and tutor availability, go to the SSC website at <http://www.mga.edu/student-success-center/>. SSC tutoring sessions may be scheduled online and face-to-face through the “Book an Appointment” link on the Student Success Center website. Other services at the SSC include online academic workshops and a robust website with resources for academic assistance. The centers also have computer workstations, printing, and Internet access.

SECTION 3 - COURSE ASSESSMENT INFORMATION

Course Assessments

Students are evaluated on programming assignments, quizzes, midterm project, and a final project.

Attendance Verification

Entry Quiz and Sample Assignment each count for 2.5 points towards your final grade.

Homework Programming Assignments

Six (6) homework assignments are worth 75 points toward the student's overall course grade. The lowest assignment grade will be dropped from the final grade calculation. No late submissions will be accepted.

Midterm Project

Midterm project is worth 30 points and will not be accepted late. Project topic, timeline and evaluation criteria will be announced in D2L. No late submissions will be accepted without prior approval.

Final Project

The final project is worth 90 points and will not be accepted late. Project topic, timeline and evaluation criteria will be announced in D2L. No late submissions will be accepted without prior approval.

Assessment Submission Policy

To obtain full credit for each assessment (assignment, project or quiz), the student must submit the assessment by its deadline in D2L. Do not send submissions to me via email. If D2L will not accept it, make sure you submit the correct file type before the deadline.

CRITERIA FOR DETERMINING THE FINAL COURSE GRADE

Final grades are computed based on:

Grading Summary

5 Assignments x 15 points each
Entry Quiz x 2.5 points
Sample Assignment x 2.5 points
Midterm Project x 30 points
Final Project x 90 points
Total of 200 points

Grading Scale

Letter Grade	Description	Grading Scale
A	Excellent work	89.5 to 100
B	Good work	79.5 to 89.49
C	Satisfactory work	69.5 to 79.49
D	Passing work	59.5 to 69.49
F	Failing work	Below 59.5

SECTION 4 - INSTRUCTOR-SPECIFIC POLICIES

Assignments, Midterm and Final Project

Assignments are hands-on coding for concepts that your instructor thinks are important. Students can discuss with classmates but cannot share the submission. The work should be done individually.

All work submitted should be done yourself.

If you get assistance from the Student Success Center (tutoring), please make a note of whom you worked with as a comment in your code.

The use of generative AI for any purpose is not allowed and is considered a violation of academic integrity.

Academic Integrity is important to me and will be reported to the Student Conduct Office. Violations will result in a zero (0) for the assessment.

No Individual extra credit will be offered, any extra credit opportunities will be announced in D2L and available to all students.

I will not “pre-grade” your code or assignment, but I will gladly look it over and help with any errors or issues you are encountering via email or during office hours. If you decide to email me about a programming assignment, please include your code in the body of your email or create a Replit and send me a link to it as Outlook blocks Python code files. Make sure your code is commented, and your question(s) are clearly articulated so I know what you are asking me.

Quizzes

Quizzes are open-note and open-book so I will not re-open a quiz that you start early as you can reference the course materials while taking it. Missed quizzes will not be re-opened.

Communicating with Instructor

There are four ways to communicate with me (in order of my preference):

- 1) [face-to-face](#)
- 2) MGA email
- 3) D2L discussion board
- 4) [Microsoft Teams](#)
- 5) phone

- Email me using your MGA Student Email and include the course name, number, and section information each time you email me.
- Please start a new email thread if you have a new issue or question instead of replying to a previous email.
- Please make sure that your e-mail/post has meaningful subject line that reads “Class Name, Class # and Section: Short description of the problem/question/request.”
- Please make sure to abide by MGA’s Communications Policy and use business appropriate language and structure in your emails.
- I will check email and discussion boards periodically and reply to your post or email as soon as I can.

I am also willing to meet before or after class with my in-person students.

Please do not use D2L Email/Messages to contact me as it is harder to send attachments and links (when necessary) through those messages, response time is delayed as I may not see the message in D2L as quickly as an Email via Outlook or Office 365 and I cannot set an autoreply in case I am unavailable.

How to Succeed in this Class

Here are the things you can do that will greatly improve your chances of making a satisfactory grade in this class:

- **Read the syllabus:** You should read every word in the syllabus during the first week of classes.
- Complete any assigned Readings and Viewings before class or watching lecture videos.
- **Allow enough time:** More unsatisfactory grades are due to procrastination than any other cause. Do not assume that you can complete the assigned work thirty minutes before the due date and time; you cannot.
- **Verify that your submission to D2L is the correct file before the deadline.** It is your responsibility to ensure that the correct file was uploaded to the correct location. I do not accept submissions via email.

What should we expect from each other?

The first and most important thing that we should expect from each other is respect and this should be shown in all interactions.

Moreover, on my side:

- I will make sure to reply to your email within 24 hours Monday through Thursday (I may not respond to emails sent during weekends [Friday – Sunday] or holidays).
- I am always open to hear your feedback about the course and I will do my best to address or incorporate your comments in the course.
- I will be available for individual or group consultation.
- I will keep the schedule updated and available in D2L.
- I will return your assignments and deliverables graded within 14 days of the deadline.
- Attendance is taken for administrative purposes; it does not affect your grade directly.

On your side, I am expecting:

- You come to class on time and actively participate in the lectures and activities.
- You talk to me if you have problems, doubts, or suggestions related to any component of the course.
- You work with effort and integrity on the assigned activities, homework, deliverables, and tests.
- Not to sleep, work on assignments for other classes or read/view unrelated materials in my class during lectures or live sessions. You will be asked to leave the classroom if you are caught doing any of these things.
- There is no need to contact me if you miss class for any reason, just catch up on any missed class sessions by getting notes from a classmate, reading the lecture slides, and watching the lecture videos (once available).

SECTION 5 - TENTATIVE COURSE SCHEDULE AND OUTLINE

The schedule below contains class activities, assignments, and deadlines. Note that the course schedule is “tentative” and subject to change based on student and/or pedagogical needs. All changes will be announced and posted on the course website.

Dates	Topics	Activities	Due Date
January 8 - January 12	Introduction & Syllabus Chapter 1 – Introduction to Java		
January 13 - January 19	Chapter 2 – Elementary Programming	Entry Quiz Sample Assignment	Friday, January 17 @ 11:59pm EST Sunday, January 19 @ 11:59pm EST
January 20 - January 26	Chapter 3 – Selections	Assignment 1	Sunday, January 26 @ 11:59pm EST
January 27 - February 2	Chapter 4 – Mathematical Functions, Characters and Strings		
February 3 - February 9	Chapter 5 - Loops	Assignment 2	Sunday, February 9 @ 11:59pm EST
February 10 - February 16	Chapter 6 – Methods		
February 17 - February 23	Chapter 7 – Single-Dimensional Arrays	Assignment 3	Sunday, February 23 @ 11:59pm EST
February 24 - March 2	Midterm Project	Midterm Project	Sunday, March 2 @ 11:59pm EST
March 3 - March 9	Chapter 8 – Multidimensional Arrays		
March 10 - March 16	Chapter 9 - Objects & Classes	Assignment 4	Sunday, March 16 @ 11:59pm EST
March 17 - March 23	Spring Break		
March 24 – March 30	Chapter 10 – Object-Oriented Thinking		
March 31 - April 6	Chapter 11 – Inheritance and Polymorphism	Assignment 5	Sunday, April 6 @ 11:59pm EST
April 7 - April 13	Chapter 12 – Exception Handling and Text I/O		
April 14 – April 20	Chapter 13 – Abstract Classes and Interfaces	Assignment 6	Sunday, April 20 @ 11:59pm EST
April 21 - April 27	Chapter 18 - Recursion		
April 28 - April 30	Review & Wrap-up	Final Project	Wednesday, April 30 th @ 11:59pm EST

SECTION 6 – INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Students are responsible for reading, understanding, and adhering to all Middle Georgia State University student policies, including those linked on the Institutional Policies page. <https://www.mga.edu/center-excellence-teaching-learning/syllabi-policies.php>

STUDENT ATTENDANCE & WITHDRAWAL POLICY

The instructor is required to report “no-shows” or students who do not show up the first day of class. Therefore, all students enrolled in the course must verify their enrollment. This can affect financial aid, and you may be dropped from the class. Your instructor will notify you as to how to verify your enrollment before the beginning of the term to ensure that you are not reported as a “no-show”.

Students are encouraged to read the withdrawal policy found at <https://www.mga.edu/registrar/registration/drop-add.php> before dropping/withdrawing from the class.

Students who wish to withdraw from the University must complete the Withdrawal Form, obtaining the required signature from the advisor, and submitting it to the Office of the Registrar at the Macon campus or the administrative offices at other campuses. Withdrawal is not complete until all withdrawal procedures have been properly executed. <https://www.mga.edu/registrar/>

Students may withdraw from the course and earn a grade of “W” up to and including the midterm date, which occurs on **March 12, 2025**. After this date students who withdraw will receive a grade of “WF.” <https://www.mga.edu/academics/calendars/index.php>

DELAYED OPENING OR CLOSING OF THE UNIVERSITY

If class is unable to occur for an opening or closing of the university, go to the online webpage of the course for additional instructions. If there are no additional instructions provided on the course homepage news section, then just plan to meet at the normal next regularly scheduled meeting for the course. Knight Alert can be used to check or <https://www.mga.edu/police/alert/index.php>

STUDENT USE OF AI IN COURSEWORK

To maintain a culture of integrity and respect, generative AI tools should not be used in the completion of course assignments unless an instructor for a given course specifically authorizes their use. Some instructors may approve of using generative AI tools in the academic setting for specific goals. However, these tools should be used only with the explicit and clear permission of each individual instructor, and then only in the ways allowed by the instructor.